

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ A K J 7 4
♥ 8 7
♦ A 7 6
♣ Q 5 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 9 6 2
♥ 9 5 2
♦ K 9
♣ 9 8 6 2

West	North	East	South
1 ♥	1 ♠		
All Pass			
1 ♠ by North			

Baker Partnership-Overcalls 1

[show NS] NORTH has an opening hand, 15 points, and a 5-card ♠ suit. Unfortunately WEST beat her to the punch by opening 1 ♥.

But NORTH should get into the bidding anyway, by Overcalling 1 ♠. This shows a good ♠ suit and somewhere between 9 and 16 points.

SOUTH has 6 points. If NORTH had actually OPENED 1 ♠, SOUTH would be obligated to bid. But knowing that the Overcall will not be made with more than 16 points, SOUTH just passes.

Board 2
 East Deals
 None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ Q 9 6 2
 ♥ T 5 2
 ♦ K Q 4
 ♣ K J 6

N
 W E
 S

♠ A K J 7 4
 ♥ 8 7
 ♦ A 7 6
 ♣ Q 5 4

West	North	East	South
		1 ♥	1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass 4 ♠ by South			

Baker Partnership-Overcalls 2
 [show NS] SOUTH has an opening hand, 15 points and five ♠s. But EAST beat him to the punch, so he overcalls 1 ♠.

NORTH has 11 points, and if SOUTH had opened she would make a Limit Raise to 3 ♠.

But when replying to an Overcall, the strength needs to be a little higher. In Deal 1 it was OK to pass a 1 ♠ Overcall with 6 points, here it is correct to just raise to 2 ♠ with 11 points.

SOUTH actually has a strong Overcall so he bids 4 ♠.

Board 3

West Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ A K J 7 4

♥ 8 7

♦ 9 7 6

♣ J 5 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 9 6 2

♥ T 5 2

♦ A K

♣ K 8 6 2

West

1 ♥

North

1 ♠

East

Pass

South

3 ♠

All Pass

3 ♠ by North

Baker Partnership-Overcalls 3

[show NS] This time NORTH has just 10 points, nowhere near an opening hand. Still, when WEST opens 1 ♥ NORTH should Overcall 1 ♠. This shows a good ♠ suit and somewhere between 9 and 16 points.

SOUTH has 13 points. If NORTH had actually OPENED 1 ♠, SOUTH would insist on game. But NORTH didn't Open, she just Overcalled. So SOUTH must be more cautious. He jumps to 3 ♠ and NORTH shows her minimum type hand by passing.

Board 4
 East Deals
 None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ A T 5 3
 ♥ T 7 5
 ♦ Q 8
 ♣ A 8 6 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 9 8 6
 ♥ 4
 ♦ A K 7 3
 ♣ K Q 7 5

West	North	East	South
		1 ♥	Dbl
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass 4 ♠ by North			

Baker Partnership-Overcalls 4

[show NS] SOUTH has 15 points, a singleton in the opponent's suit and 4-card support for any suit partner might name. In other words, a perfect Takeout Double.

NORTH needs to make a medium-strong bid to apprise SOUTH of her 10 points. She jumps to 2 ♠.

SOUTH's hand is now worth 17 points because of the singleton. Since he is quite happy with ♠s he bids 4 ♠.

Board 5

West Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ 5 3
♥ A J 4 2
♦ K Q J
♣ K 7 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 7 6 4 2
♥ 7 6 3
♦ 8 6 4
♣ J 9 8

West	North	East	South
1 ♠	Dbl	Pass	2 ♣
All Pass			
2 ♣ by South			

Baker Partnership-Overcalls 5

[show NS] NORTH has 14 points, a doubleton in the opponent's ♠ suit and at least three cards in each of the other suits. This is a normal Takeout Double.

SOUTH has a really awful hand. He has just one point and his only 4-card suit is the one the opponents have already bid. He wants nothing more than to pass.

But he cannot pass. Partner's Double said "Bid your best suit.", so he bids 2 ♣.

Mercifully NORTH also passes.

Board 6
 East Deals
 None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ A J T 7
 ♥ J 7
 ♦ Q J 9 5
 ♣ A 8 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 9 8 5
 ♥ K Q T 5
 ♦ A K 3
 ♣ 4 2

West	North	East	South
		1 ♣	Dbl
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			

Baker Partnership-Overcalls 6

[show NS] With 14 points, ♣ shortage, and support for the other suits SOUTH makes a Takeout Double.

NORTH has 13 points so she bids 2 ♣. This is an artificial bid, apprising SOUTH of NORTH's opening hand strength, and forcing the partnership to reach the game level.

SOUTH suggests ♥s as trumps. NORTH doesn't like ♥s so she suggests ♠s. SOUTH agrees with ♠s and bids game, 4 ♠.

Board 7
West Deals
None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ Q 7 4
♥ 9 6 5 2
♦ Q 5
♣ A 8 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K J 9 8 3
♥ 7
♦ A K J 3
♣ 7 5

West	North	East	South
1 ♥	Pass	Pass	Dbl
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass 4 ♠ by South			

Baker Partnership-Overcalls 7

[show NS] WEST's 1 ♥ opening is passed around to SOUTH. He is tempted to overcall 1 ♠, but with 18 points is a little strong for a mere overcall. Instead, he doubles.

With 8 points NORTH is not strong enough to jump. She bids 2 ♣.

SOUTH now bids 2 ♠. By doubling first, then bidding his own suit, he shows a good suit and 17+ points.

NORTH raises to 4 ♠.

Board 8

East Deals

None Vul

♠	-	♠	-
♥	-	♥	-
♦	-	♦	-
♣	-	♣	-

♠ 8 7
 ♥ A 9 7 6
 ♦ A 6 2
 ♣ K 9 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A J 9
 ♥ K Q 8
 ♦ Q 7 4
 ♣ A Q 8 5

West	North	East	South
		1 ♠	1NT
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	2 ♦
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			

Baker Partnership-Overcalls 8

[show NS] SOUTH has 18 points, a balanced hand, and a good stopper in their suit. He should overcall 1NT. For 1NT overcalls, the range is increased to 15-18 points.

NORTH bids 2 ♣ (Stayman), just as she would with a 1NT opening. When SOUTH denies holding a 4-card Major NORTH has enough points to bid 3NT. She doesn't worry about a ♠ stopper since SOUTH promised he had the suit controlled.

Board 9

West Deals

None Vul

♠	-		♠	-
♥	-		♥	-
♦	-		♦	-
♣	-		♣	-

♠ A 8 6

♥ K Q J

♦ A J 9 7

♣ K Q 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J T 5 2

♥ 7 6 4 2

♦ 8 6

♣ J 8 6

West

1 ♦

Pass

All Pass

1NT by North

North

Dbl

1NT

East

Pass

South

1 ♠

Baker Partnership-Overcalls 9

[show NS] NORTH has 20 points, excellent ♦ stoppers and a balanced hand. She is two points too strong to overcall 1NT. Instead, she doubles.

SOUTH has an awful hand - but since he is forced to bid he says 1 ♠, assuming NORTH wants to hear his best suit.

NORTH now bids 1NT, showing the balanced 19-21 point hand. SOUTH passes, of course.

Board 10

East Deals

None Vul

♠	-	♠	-
♥	-	♥	-
♦	-	♦	-
♣	-	♣	-

♠ K J 6 2

♥ 6 5

♦ A Q 3

♣ 9 8 7 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 7 4

♥ A Q T

♦ K J 7 5

♣ A K 6

West	North	East	South
------	-------	------	-------

		1 ♥	Dbl
--	--	-----	-----

Pass	2 ♠	Pass	3NT
------	-----	------	-----

All Pass
3NT by South

Baker Partnership-Overcalls 10

[show NS] SOUTH has a 19 point balanced hand, including a stop in ♥s. He plans to double, then bid NT. (see Deal 9)

NORTH has 10 points though, so he jumps to 2 ♠.

In theory SOUTH could now bid 2NT to continue the description of his hand, but he might as well go ahead and bid 3NT instead.

Board 11
West Deals
None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ A Q T 5 3
♥ 6 4
♦ Q T
♣ A 9 7 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K J 4 2
♥ A 8 5
♦ K J 3 2
♣ J 2

West	North	East	South
1 ♥	1 ♠	Pass	3 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			

Baker Partnership-Overcalls 11
[show NS] With a 5-card ♠ suit and 13 points
NORTH should overcall 1 ♠.

SOUTH has 13 points and four ♠s. If NORTH had opened, SOUTH's hand would be good enough to insist on game. But since NORTH overcalled, SOUTH merely invites with a jump to 3 ♠.

NORTH has better than a minimum overcall so she accepts the invitation and bids 4 ♠.

Board 12
East Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ Q 3

♥ K Q 9 8 6 4

♦ A 5 2

♣ 9 5

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ K J 6 4

♥ J T 7 5

♦ 6

♣ A K J 3

West	North	East	South
		1 ♦	
Pass	4 ♥		
All Pass			
4 ♥ by North			

Baker Partnership-Overcalls 12
[show NS] SOUTH has a very minimum Takeout
Double of 1 ♦. But what it lacks in strength, it makes
up for with perfect distribution.

NORTH has 13 points and only wants to play in one
contract, 4 ♥.

SOUTH passes happily.

Board 13
West Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ A T 9 4

♥ K Q J 7

♦ Q 6

♣ A Q 4

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ J 7 6

♥ T 5 2

♦ A J 9 4

♣ K T 2

West	North	East	South
1 ♦	Dbl	Pass	1NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			

Baker Partnership-Overcalls 13
[show NS] NORTH has 18 points, a doubleton in the opponent's suit, and at least three cards in the unbid suits. This is an ideal hand for a Takeout Double.

SOUTH has good strength in WEST's ♦ suit, probably two stoppers. He has 9 points and no 4-card suit of his own. This is the type of hand to respond 1NT.

NORTH is happy to play Notrump now that she knows the ♦ s are covered, so she bids 3NT.

Board 14

East Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ Q 8
♥ A J 9 2
♦ A J 6
♣ Q 9 8 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K 9 6 4
♥ Q 5
♦ K 7 4
♣ J T 7

West	North	East	South
		1 ♥	1 ♠
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT

All Pass
3NT by North

Baker Partnership-Overcalls 14

[show NS] SOUTH has an opening hand, 14 points and five ♠s. But EAST beat him to the punch, so he overcalls 1 ♠.

NORTH also has 14 points, she doesn't care too much for ♠s, but she has an excellent stopper in ♥s. She jumps to 2NT, inviting SOUTH to bid game.

Since SOUTH has several points more than he might have had, and no 6-card ♠ suit to rebid, he happily bids 3NT.

Board 15
West Deals
None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ 8 7
♥ K Q 9 7
♦ A K 8 3
♣ Q J 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 9 3
♥ J T 5 3
♦ Q 5
♣ A K 8 6

West	North	East	South
1 ♠	Dbl	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	3 ♥	Pass	4 ♥
All Pass			
4 ♥ by North			

Baker Partnership-Overcalls 15
[show NS] NORTH has 15 points and all the requirements for a Takeout Double of 1 ♠.

With 14 points of his own, SOUTH knows his side needs to be in a game somewhere. He passes this information to NORTH with a cue-bid of 2 ♠.

NORTH gets the message and starts the hunt for a trump fit by bidding 3 ♥. That makes it easy for SOUTH - he bids 4 ♥.

Board 16

East Deals

None Vul

♠ -	♠ K 7 5	♠ -
♥ -	♥ 8 5 2	♥ -
♦ -	♦ K Q 3	♦ -
♣ -	♣ 9 7 6 2	♣ -
	N W E S	
	♠ A Q J 6 4 2	
	♥ A 7	
	♦ J 7 2	
	♣ A 8	

West	North	East	South
		1 ♥	Dbl
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			

Baker Partnership-Overcalls 16

[show NS] There is only one reason that SOUTH should not overcall with 1 ♠. He is too strong. The maximum strength of an overcall is 16 points. Above that you should double.

So SOUTH doubles, and after NORTH bids 2 ♣, SOUTH bids 2 ♠. This shows an overcall type hand, but with 17 or more points.

NORTH has fine trump support and 8 points so she bids a confident 4 ♠.

Board 17
West Deals
None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ K 9 8 3
♥ 7 6
♦ K Q 5
♣ A J 7 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q J 2
♥ A K 4 3
♦ 7 4
♣ K Q 8 2

West	North	East	South
1 ♦	Pass	Pass	Dbl
Pass	2 ♦	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	3 ♣
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by North			

Baker Partnership-Overcalls 17

[show NS] NORTH has 13 points but has no bid over 1 ♦. SOUTH can make a Takeout Double, so he does.

NORTH now cue-bids ♦ to show opening hand strength.

SOUTH shows his ♥ suit, NORTH doesn't like it. NORTH shows her ♠ suit, SOUTH doesn't like it. SOUTH shows his ♣ suit, NORTH likes it fine, but decides 3NT will be easier than 5 ♣.

Board 18

East Deals

None Vul

♠	-	♠	-
♥	-	♥	-
♦	-	♦	-
♣	-	♣	-

♠ 9 6

♥ Q 6 5

♦ J 7 5 4

♣ K T 6 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A J T 7 4

♥ A 7 3

♦ A 8 6

♣ 9 5

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

All Pass
1 ♠ by East

Baker Partnership-Overcalls 18

[show NS] SOUTH would have had a great opening 1 ♠ bid. But when EAST opened 1 ♠ in front of him he was hornswaggled. He couldn't bid any other suit, he couldn't bid 1NT and he sure couldn't bid ♠s. So he must pass.

And so does everybody else pass.

Board 19
West Deals
None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ K Q J 9 7 5 3
♥ 7 4
♦ Q 3
♣ 6 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 8 2
♥ J 5 2
♦ K 9 8 6
♣ 7 5 3

West	North	East	South
1 ♣	3 ♠		
All Pass 3 ♠ by North			

Baker Partnership-Overcalls 19

[show NS] If West had passed, NORTH would have opened with a preemptive 3 ♠.

She should make the same bid with the same hand AFTER the opponents open. And she makes it for the same reason, to describe her hand and to take away bidding space from the opponents.

SOUTH treats it just like a Preemptive 3-bid, even though it is now called a Weak Jump Overcall. In this case, SOUTH passes.

Board 20
East Deals
None Vul

♠ -	♠ K 7 2	♠ -
♥ -	♥ Q J 5 4	♥ -
♦ -	♦ 6 3	♦ -
♣ -	♣ 9 8 6 4	♣ -
	♠ N ♥ W E ♦ S ♣	
	♠ A J T 8 5	
	♥ 6 3	
	♦ A J T 8 5	
	♣ 3	

West	North	East	South
		1 ♣	1 ♠

All Pass
1 ♠ by South

Baker Partnership-Overcalls 20
[show NS] SOUTH has 12 points, but with two 5-card suits worthy of an overcall. There isn't really a right and wrong here, but it usually works out best to overcall in the higher-ranking suit. That leaves open the possibility of bidding the second suit later.

In this Deal, after SOUTH overcalls 1 ♠, that later possibility never happens because everybody should pass.

Board 21
West Deals
None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ A 5 3
♥ 4 2
♦ A K 2
♣ J 7 6 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 8 6
♥ Q 8 6 3
♦ 9 8 4 3
♣ 8 5

West	North	East	South
1 ♠			
All Pass			
1 ♠ by West			

Baker Partnership-Overcalls 21

[show NS] NORTH has 13 points but she has to pass. She cannot Double without support for ♥s. She cannot bid 1NT without 2 more points. She cannot overcall 2♣ with a terrible suit like that.

And SOUTH of course must also pass.

Board 22

East Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ T 3

♥ K J 7 6

♦ K J 5

♣ A Q 7 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q J 8 4 2

♥ Q 2

♦ Q 8 7

♣ 8 3

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

Pass

Dbl

All Pass
1 ♠ by East

Baker Partnership-Overcalls 22

[show NS] SOUTH obviously has to pass when EAST opens 1 ♠.

NORTH has a reasonable Takeout Double. She hopes SOUTH will name a suit and they can just play a partscore.

You should almost always bid when partner makes a Takeout Double. Almost always. This is the one time when you don't. SOUTH's ♠ are so good that he passes, converting the Takeout Double into a Penalty Double.

Board 23

West Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ A K 8 7 2

♥ J 9 8

♦ K 7 6

♣ 6 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q J 5

♥ A K Q 2

♦ A 9 8 5

♣ 4 2

West

1 ♣

North

1 ♠

East

Pass

South

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by North

Baker Partnership-Overcalls 23

[show NS] NORTH has a normal overcall of 1 ♠.

SOUTH has a really good hand, but he doesn't have to worry about missing a slam since NORTH will not have more than 16 points. So he just bids what he thinks NORTH can make, 4 ♠.

Board 24
East Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ T 6 5

♥ 8 4

♦ K J T 3

♣ A J 8 4

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ K Q 3

♥ K Q J 5 3

♦ 9 6 5

♣ T 6

West	North	East	South
		1 ♦	1 ♥
Pass	1NT		
All Pass			
1NT by North			

Baker Partnership-Overcalls 24
[show NS] SOUTH has 12 points and a good enough suit to overcall 1♥.

NORTH has 9 points with a good ♦ stopper. She bids 1NT.

SOUTH has nothing more to say, and lets NORTH play 1NT.